

1.INTRODUCTION

Subliminal perception is when your brain notices and reacts to things that you are not consciously aware of. These things could be pictures, sounds, or even feelings that are very faint or quick, so you do not notice them. Even though you don't notice them, they can still affect how you feel and act. This is interesting because it shows that our minds can pick up on things without us realising it.

For example, sometimes advertisers try to use subliminal messages in their ads. They might flash images or words quickly, hoping to influence what you buy without you knowing it. While some people think this works, others say it's not as powerful as people think. Still, research has shown that these hidden messages can have a small impact on what we like or choose to buy.

Scientists also study subliminal perception to understand how it affects our emotions and thoughts. They have found that even though we don't consciously see or hear things, our brains can still react to them. For instance, seeing happy faces without realising it can make us feel happier, while scary images can make us feel anxious, all without us knowing why.

But there are debates about whether using subliminal messages is right. Some people worry it is sneaky and could manipulate us without our permission. Others think it could be useful for therapy, like helping people overcome fears or addictions.

In short, studying subliminal perception helps us understand more about how our minds work. Even though it is controversial and there are limits to its effects, it is still an important area of research with implications for psychology, advertising, and therapy.

2. "The Influence of Subliminal Advertising on Consumer Behavior"

2.1. How is it used in marketing?

In marketing, subliminal perception refers to the use of deceptive techniques to affect your purchases without you being aware of it.

This is how it operates: Ads may contain hidden messages that your brain interprets as sounds or visuals without your awareness. For instance, a photograph may subtly convey information that encourages you to purchase the item.

Colors and Designs: Marketers can evoke specific feelings in you regarding a product by using certain colors and designs. Red and yellow are popular colors in fast food establishments because they provoke feelings of hunger and impatience.

Product placement: Subtle product placement can be seen in television series or films. You're more inclined to purchase them later if you see them there.

Using Your Senses: Some stores use scents to make you feel good while you shop. Have you ever walked into a bakery and suddenly felt hungry? That's because they're pumping out yummy smells that make you want to buy their goods. It's a sneaky way to get you to spend more money.

Tricky Packaging: You know those glitzy packaging designs that give goods such an alluring appearance? They're not only decorative; they're intended to provide the impression that the product is superior to what it actually is. Occasionally, they will deceive you into believing a product is healthier or more opulent than it actually is by using words or images.

Getting Your Brain Ready: Occasionally, the mere sight of an advertisement increases your likelihood of making a purchase later on. For instance, you might get thirsty if you saw a billboard featuring an image of a mouthwatering beverage. Your brain may recall the thirst from the billboard, making you more likely to purchase a drink later on while you're at the shop.

Repetition: Have you ever noticed that some ads repeat the same message repeatedly? That is not by accident. Marketers know that the more you hear or see something, the more likely you are to remember it and maybe even buy it. It's like when you hear a catchy song on the radio—you might find yourself humming it later without even realizing why.

Celebrity Endorsements: Ever see your favorite celebrity promoting a product? Companies use celebrities because they know you trust and admire them. So, when you see a famous person using a product, you might want it too, even if you don't consciously think about it.

Social Proof: Ever seen ads that say things like "Join the millions who love our product" or "Best-selling item of the year"? These messages are trying to convince you that everyone else is using or loving the product, so you should too. It is a way to make you feel like you're missing out if you don't buy it.

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Social Proof: Have you ever seen advertisements with phrases like "Best-selling item of the year" or "Join the millions who love our product"? The purpose of these communications is to persuade you that since everyone else is utilizing or enjoying the thing, you need to too. If you don't buy it, it's a tactic to make you feel as if you're missing out.

FOMO (Fear of Missing Out): Some advertisements deceive you into thinking you must purchase something immediately. They might employ language such as "Offer valid until supplies are exhausted" or "Time-limited opportunity" to evoke a feeling of urgency. This impulse to buy before you have had a chance to consider it can be caused by your fear of missing out.

Emotional Appeal: Have you ever noticed how certain advertisements make you feel something? They could use touching tales, adorable animals, or happy families to evoke strong emotions in you. An advertisement that emotionally resonates with you increases the likelihood that you will remember it and want to support the company running it.

Influencer marketing: Businesses collaborate with social media influencers, or users who have substantial followings on sites like Instagram and YouTube, in a manner akin to celebrity endorsements. Because you respect their perspectives, you may be more likely to purchase things that influencers endorse in their posts or videos.

Personalization: Businesses may now follow your browsing patterns and display adverts that are specially tailored to you thanks to the growth of online purchasing and targeted advertising. Have you ever noticed how occasionally the web advertisements appear to know precisely what you have been looking at? Because of this tailored approach, the advertisements feel more relevant to you and you are more likely to click on them or buy something.

Drink Brands Study: This study investigated if people's choice of drink was influenced, particularly if they were thirsty, when they were discreetly shown the name of a certain brand.

The Simpsons Study: Another study discovered that viewers became thirstier simply by seeing the term "thirsty" or an image of a Coca-Cola can during a brief episode of The Simpsons.

The Effectiveness of Subliminal Messaging: Research has shown that reverse-typing a brand's name in advertisements causes many consumers to favor that particular rum brand.

Environmental Cues: Several specialists assert that, even when we are not aware of it, the objects in our immediate surroundings might influence our behavior.

Store Music Affects Sales: Research indicates that playing mellow music in stores encourages customers to make larger purchases and move more slowly,

In the UK, subliminal messaging is prohibited: Because of ethical and fairness concerns, using subliminal messages in advertisements is prohibited in the United Kingdom.

2.2. Real life Examples of Subliminal Marketing

Let's examine some effective instances of subliminal messaging. A successful subliminal message should evoke a sense of uncovering a playful "hidden message" rather than feeling deceived or manipulated. By employing the right tactics, marketers can ensure that the audience feels included in the discovery, rather than being the subject of a joke.

These instances of subliminal advertising serve as compelling demonstrations of the remarkable efficacy of this approach.

Amazon:



Amazon, a leading e-commerce giant, employs subtle marketing techniques that appeal to consumers' subconscious minds without overtly influencing their behavior. Through strategic design elements, personalized recommendations, and subtle messaging, Amazon creates an immersive shopping experience that resonates with consumers on a subconscious level.

The key to Amazon's subliminal perception marketing style lies in making consumers feel like they've stumbled upon a delightful secret rather than being manipulated. For example, Amazon's recommendation algorithms subtly guide users towards products based on their browsing history and purchase behavior, creating a personalized shopping journey that feels intuitive and effortless.

Moreover, Amazon's website design incorporates subtle cues such as color psychology and layout optimization to enhance user engagement and encourage prolonged browsing. The use of vibrant colors, strategic placement of product images, and intuitive navigation features all contribute to creating a seamless and enjoyable shopping experience that resonates with consumers on a subconscious level.

Additionally, Amazon leverages social proof and user-generated content to subtly influence consumer perceptions. Customer reviews, ratings, and endorsements from trusted sources create a sense of authenticity and credibility, subtly nudging consumers towards making informed purchasing decisions.

At first glance, the Amazon logo looks like it is underlined by a smile but look closer – the smile is a kind of arrow! The smile at the bottom of the 'AMAZ' includes an arrowhead, starting at the

A and ending with the Z. This demonstrates that they offer a comprehensive range of products, covering all your needs from start to finish.

Overall, Amazon's subliminal perception marketing style revolves around creating a seamless and personalized shopping experience that resonates with consumers on a subconscious level. By employing subtle cues and strategic design elements, Amazon ensures that consumers feel empowered and in control of their purchasing journey, fostering trust and loyalty towards the brand

FedEx:



FedEx's logo design serves as an example of subliminal perception in branding. The logo ingeniously integrates a concealed arrow within the empty space between the "E" and the "x", representing progress and velocity. This subtle element subtly communicates FedEx's commitment to prompt and efficient delivery services.

The use of the arrow in the logo subtly reinforces the brand's image without overtly influencing consumer behavior. Instead of feeling deceived, consumers appreciate the ingenuity of the design and feel as though they have uncovered a hidden message within the logo.

In essence, FedEx's incorporation of subliminal perception in its branding demonstrates how subtle design elements can effectively convey brand messaging and leave a positive impression on consumers. Through the discreet inclusion of the arrow, FedEx subtly communicates its dedication to swift and reliable service, resonating with consumers on a subconscious level.

Disney and Pirates of the Caribbean:



Disney's "Pirates of the Caribbean" franchise has sparked speculation about subliminal perception in its films. One example is a scene in "The Curse of the Black Pearl," where Captain Jack Sparrow walks along a beach with a mysterious figure hidden in the shadows. Some viewers suggest the silhouette resembles a woman's torso, hinting at sensuality.

Similarly, the movie poster for "The Curse of the Black Pearl" features smoke from Captain Jack Sparrow's gun forming a skull shape. This imagery subtly conveys the adventurous tone of the film while evoking associations with danger and excitement.

Though Disney denies intentional use of subliminal messaging, these instances demonstrate how viewers may interpret imagery in ways that suggest hidden messages. Disney emphasizes its commitment to family-friendly entertainment, but these examples illustrate how subtle cues can influence audience perception and engagement with the content.

Tostitos:



The subliminal message behind the Tostitos logo lies in its clever design, which subtly reinforces the brand's association with social interaction and enjoyment. By depicting two people sharing a chip dipped in salsa, with the dot of the "I" representing a bowl of salsa between them, the logo evokes feelings of camaraderie, fun, and sharing.

This subliminal message taps into consumers' subconscious desire for social connection and enjoyment, subtly suggesting that Tostitos snacks are perfect for gatherings, parties, and shared experiences. The imagery of people sharing a chip and dip reinforces the idea of Tostitos as a snack that brings people together, enhancing the overall appeal of the brand and its products.

Baskin and Robbins:



Baskin Robbins offers 31 flavors of ice cream. It's a subtle detail, but the message is clear: the "B" and "R" in the logo cleverly incorporate the number "31". This subtle inclusion reinforces the company's distinctive selling point: a wide selection of flavors to indulge in.

However, what may surprise you is that Baskin Robbins has also dabbled in subliminal advertising. In fact, the company once employed a subliminal message to highlight the abundance of flavors it offers.

3.SUBLIMINAL CUES USED AND THE RATIONALE

In ads and marketing, small things can make a big difference. We're looking at why we replaced the apple with a smartphone in a picture of Adam and Eve in the Garden of Eden. Let's see what hidden messages this change sends.

Smartphone Symbolism:

Using smartphones in the picture has a special meaning. The apple usually stands for knowledge and temptation in the story of Adam and Eve. But by switching it with a smartphone, we're saying something new. Smartphones are everywhere now, and they affect how we live and think.

Hidden Messages:

1. Learning and Staying Connected: Like the apple, the smartphone is also about learning new things and staying in touch with others. By showing Adam and Eve with smartphones, we're saying that just like in the old story, people today also want to know more and connect with others.

2. Feeling Tempted to Buy: Smartphones aren't just for talking. They're also about wanting things. People often want the latest phone because it's cool. So, by showing Adam and Eve with smartphones, we're saying that just like the old story, people today also feel tempted by new stuff.

3. Getting Further from Nature: In the old story, eating the apple made Adam and Eve leave the Garden of Eden. This means they got far from nature. Today, smartphones can make us focus more on screens than on nature. So, by putting smartphones in the Garden of Eden, we're saying that too much focus on phones can keep us from enjoying nature.

3.1. Conclusion:

Changing the apple to a smartphone in the Garden of Eden picture shows how our modern world is connected to ancient stories. We want people to think about how much smartphones affect our lives. Knowing how small changes can send big messages helps advertisers make ads that really get people thinking.

4. Test Group Description:

Importance

Clarity and Understanding: A clear description helps readers or stakeholders understand the characteristics of the individuals or entities being studied. It ensures that everyone involved has a clear picture of who is included in the test group and who is not.

Validity and Reliability: A well-described test group contributes to the validity and reliability of the research findings. If the characteristics of the test group are clearly defined, researchers can better assess whether the results accurately represent the population or phenomenon being studied.

Generalizability: Understanding the characteristics of the test group helps researchers determine the extent to which the findings can be generalized to other populations or contexts. A detailed description allows researchers to assess the applicability of the findings beyond the specific study.

Transparency and Accountability: A detailed description promotes transparency and accountability in research. It allows readers to evaluate the methods and procedures used in the study and assess the credibility of the findings.

A questionnaire-based survey was conducted among MBA college students aged 20 to 24. The questionnaire consisted of multiple-choice and open-ended questions designed to assess participants' perception of the subliminal message conveyed by the poster. Participants were

asked to indicate their age, gender, and familiarity with the concept of subliminal perception. They were then shown the poster and asked to provide their immediate thoughts and associations.

Group Compositions: The survey included 10 MBA college students, evenly distributed between ages 20 to 24, with an equal participation of male and female participants.

Inclusion and Exclusion Criteria:

Eligible participants for this study are students currently enrolled in the MBA program at Alliance Ascent College. Specifically, inclusion is limited to individuals actively pursuing their MBA degree at Alliance Ascent College.

Exclusion Criteria: Excluded from participation are students enrolled in undergraduate programs such as BBA and B. Com at Alliance Ascent College. Only MBA students at Alliance Ascent College are included in the study, while undergraduates are excluded from consideration.

Objectives:

To assess the test group's awareness, understanding, and perceptions of subliminal perception marketing by presenting them with a poster containing subliminal elements and collecting feedback through a structured questionnaire. We Administered a questionnaire consisting of sets of questions related to the Awareness of subliminal perception marketing, Understanding of its usage in marketing, Feedback on the given poster. This study aims to provide insights into how individuals perceive and interpret subliminal messages in marketing materials, informing future research and marketing strategies.

5.QUESTIONNAIRE:

- Response Number
- Respondent Email
- Date Submitted
- Have you heard about the concept of subliminal perception before?
- Name
- Have you ever knowingly been exposed to subliminal messages (e.g., in advertisements, movies, music)?
- Do you think it's important to educate consumers about the use of subliminal messaging in advertising?
- How do you envision the role of subliminal messaging evolving in the future of marketing?
- What is your initial reaction to the poster featuring Adam and Eve using a smartphone in the Garden of Eden?
- How would you describe the overall mood or atmosphere of the poster?

- What elements of the poster caught your attention first?
- Do you notice any symbolism or themes in the poster? If so, please describe.
- How do you interpret the use of Adam and Eve in a contemporary setting such as the Garden of Eden with a smartphone?
- How do you think the use of subliminal marketing techniques, if any, is incorporated into this poster?
- Are there any changes or improvements you would suggest for this poster to make it more effective or impactful?
- How does this poster align with your personal values or beliefs? Does it challenge or reinforce them in any way?
- Do you think subliminal messaging be seamlessly integrated into digital marketing channels such as social media or online advertising?
- What are the key challenges and limitations associated with incorporating subliminal messaging into marketing strategies, and how can they be overcome?

6.Responses from the test group:

This study offers valuable insights into how people perceive and interpret visual stimuli, especially in marketing contexts. While not directly introduced, the concept of subliminal perception seemed to influence respondents' reactions to the poster. Let's delve into the findings and consider their implications for marketing strategies:

1. Awareness of Subliminal Perception:

- A significant portion (55%) of participants were familiar with subliminal perception, indicating an existing awareness among the target audience.
- This suggests consumers may have preconceived ideas about subtle messaging in ads, which could impact their responses to marketing efforts.

2. First Impressions:

- Respondents' initial attention varied, with many focusing on Adam and Eve's depiction (44%) and the poster's color scheme (33%).
- This diversity in first impressions underscores the need to incorporate multiple attention-grabbing elements to engage different audience segments effectively.

3. Interpretation and Theme:

- Participants interpreted the poster's theme differently, with some seeing it as a blend of ancient and modern elements symbolizing technological progress (55%).
- The association of the couple with smartphones, especially in a natural setting like a forest, led to connections with brands like Apple, indicating the potential for effective brand association through subtle imagery.

4. Views on Subliminal Marketing Techniques:

- A notable portion of respondents (44%) recognized the incorporation of brand logos or symbols as a form of subliminal marketing, highlighting the importance of subtle branding strategies.
- Additionally, the use of colors to evoke emotions (44%) demonstrates the power of visual elements in shaping consumer perceptions and attitudes towards brands or products.

5. Open-ended Feedback:

- Suggestions to replace background fruits with apples and the challenge some participants faced in understanding the poster due to unfamiliarity with the Adam and Eve story underscore the importance of aligning visual elements with brand messaging and audience knowledge.

6. Respect for Personal Values:

- Crucially, no participants felt disrespected or annoyed by the poster, indicating its success in navigating potentially sensitive themes without alienating viewers.
- This highlights the importance of maintaining brand integrity and respecting diverse cultural backgrounds and beliefs in marketing campaigns.

In summary, this research highlights the intricate nature of consumer perception and the potential effectiveness of subtle messaging in marketing. For college marketing teams, these findings underscore the importance of thoughtful design, strategic brand association, and sensitivity to diverse audience backgrounds when creating visual marketing materials. Additionally, they emphasize leveraging existing consumer awareness and perceptions to craft engaging and impactful campaigns.

7.Conclusion:

In summary, the study looked at what people think about hidden messages in ads, using a poster of Adam and Eve with smartphones as an example. Most of the students surveyed knew something about hidden messages in ads, showing they already had some ideas about it. We found that people noticed different things first when they looked at the poster, like Adam and Eve or the colors used. They thought the poster showed a mix of old and new things, representing progress. They also understood that brands use symbols and colors to make people like their products more.

People gave some suggestions to make the poster better, like using apples instead of other fruits and making sure everyone understands the story behind Adam and Eve. It was important that nobody felt bad or annoyed by the poster, showing it was made in a respectful way. Overall, the study gives us ideas on how to make ads that people like and understand better. We need to think about what people already know and like, and use that in our ads to make them more effective.

8.Reference:

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